flames themselves."

Sutoku's forces were scattered, and the Cloistered Emperor himself was arrested and exiled. Yoshitomo had his own father put to death—a cold-blooded and vicious decision that, says the *Gukansho*, caused "some commotion around the country." Tametomo was allowed to live, but the sinews of his arms were cut so that he could no longer use a bow.[9]

Minamoto Yoshitomo considered himself the architect of Emperor Go-Shirakawa's victory, but when the normal business of government resumed, a Taira clan member named Kiyomori (who had joined the emperor's cause *after* Yoshitomo) managed to gain a higher position at court, and the emperor's apparent favor. Before long, Yoshitomo and Kiyomori were at odds; and the hostility between them was fanned by a Fujiwara clansman named Nobuyori, who himself felt unappreciated by the emperor. "Having noted rivalry between Minamoto Yoshitomo and Taira Kiyomori," the *Gukansho* explains, "and having assumed that the victor in a war between them would seize control of the state, he allied himself with Minamoto Yoshitomo . . . and began immediately to plot a rebellion."[10]

The inevitable fight—the Heiji Disturbance—broke out in 1159.

Go-Shirakawa had just abdicated in favor of his teenaged son, who became the emperor Nijo; Yoshitomo and Nobuyori waited until their Taira rival Kiyomori left the capital city Kyoto on a pilgrimage of devotion to Kumano, a sacred site nearly 175 miles of mountainous road away. When he was well away, five hundred Minamoto samurai surrounded the palace of the Cloistered Emperor Go-Shirakawa, took him prisoner, and set his palace on fire. Others kidnapped the young emperor.

